Compound eyes

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Word bank

lenses surface eyes above far sides insects
compound produce vision

Arthropods such as i_____ are the only animals that have **compound eyes**. Compound e_____ are made up of many small l_____. Each lens is positioned on the s_____ of a hemisphere. They can see a_____, below, behind, to the s_____ and straight in front, all at once. All these views p_____ a mosaic image, like the pixels in an enlarged photograph. The more lenses, the better the insect's v_____. The insect cannot see very f_____ – the c_____ eye is better suited to detecting movement, rather than detail.

2 Why do bees visit windblown flowers more than still flowers? _____

_____

3 Why is it so hard to catch a dragonfly? _____

_____

4 Why do grasshoppers have poorer vision than bees? _____

_____

5 Label these statements true or false.

a) Only arthropods have compound eyes. _____

b) Insects can see in many directions at once. _____

c) Compound eyes take photographs. _____

d) Compound eyes are good at detecting movement. _____

e) A compound eye has only one lens. _____

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